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Al-Ahsa National Park

INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITY

Environmental services

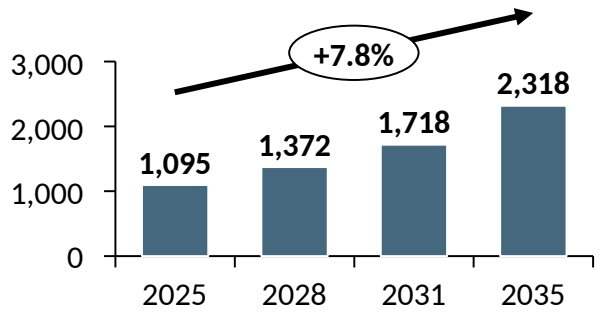
استثمر في السعودية
INVEST SAUDI

Environmental services
Proposed investment site within Al-Ahsa National Park for ecotourism assets and activities

OPPORTUNITY DESCRIPTION: **Developing an ecotourism site within Al-Ahsa National Park (e.g., camps, museum, etc.)**

DEMAND

MARKET SIZE, USD



INVESTMENT OVERVIEW

INVESTMENT HIGHLIGHTS PROPOSITION

- Expected Investment size: SAR 34 Million
- Expected IRR: 22%
- Payback: 7 years
- Cumulative GDP Impact[2]: SAR 260 Million
- Cumulative[2] Job Creation: 46
- Location (Region): Al-Ahsa Governate, Eastern Region

VALUE PROPOSITION

- Accessibility from population centers (within Al-Hofuf and ~160 km from Dammam), allows for a large, serviceable market of residents/tourists
- High accessibility driven by developed roads and infrastructure
- The proposed site already has visibility among locals as evidenced by existing visitorship to Al-Ahsa National Park
- On-site vegetation allows operators to provide various outdoor, nature-based activities

MARKET OVERVIEW

KEY DEMAND DRIVERS

- Growing investments into sustainable tourism projects (e.g., AMAALA) suggest that ecotourism is expected to grow in popularity
- Plans for ecotourism destinations in the Eastern Region specifically are also gaining traction (e.g., TDF's[3] Half Moon Beach Resort announced in 2024)
- The Eastern Province has seen a ~377% growth in tourists and a 280% rise in spending from '21 to '23

GLOBAL TRENDS

- The global ecotourism market is seeing strong growth, valued at $185.87 billion USD as of 2021 and expected to grow at a 15.2% CAGR until 2030, with market tailwinds including:
- **Rising demand for nature-based tourism:** nature-based tourism constitutes a significant portion of global tourism market, with rapid growth observed over past decade
- **Increased accessibility through enhanced polices:** many countries are implementing more relaxed visa policies to boost tourism (e.g., Saudi Arabia has introduced an eVisa system, offering a one-year, multiple-entry visa, allowing tourists to spend up to 90 days in the country, thereby facilitating increased international visitation)

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OPPORTUNITY DESCRIPTION: Developing ecolodge resort within the Uruq Bani Ma'arid Protected Area

SUPPLY

SCALABILITY AND LOCALIZATION

Grade: Low | Medium | **High**

- NCVC will lease the land to the investor for long-term, which the investor would monetize through the development of accommodation assets (e.g., camps), recreational assets (e.g., children's playground), or activities (e.g., hiking)

IMPORT DEPENDENCY

- The Environment Fund offers loan guarantees to help subsidize capital expenditures for opportunities requiring infrastructure development
- The National Center for Vegetation Cover Development and Combating Desertification will offer the private sector the land at a discounted rate to develop and offer assets/activities, with a grace period of up to 2 years before lease payments begin

ENABLING FACTORS

ENABLERS & INCENTIVES

- The Environment Fund offers loan guarantees to help subsidize capital expenditures for opportunities requiring infrastructure development
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VALUE CHAIN

Raw Materials	Development	Services	Applications
Natural Sites & Landscapes	Camps & Facilities	Accommodation & Recreational activities	Tourism, leisure, & Eco-experiences

KEY STAKEHOLDERS

- Saudi Tourism Authority
- Environment Fund
- National Center for Vegetation Cover Development & Combating Desertification (NCVC)
- Ministry of Environment, Water and Agriculture
- Ministry of Tourism

COST OF DOING BUSINESS IN KSA

Factor	amongst regional peers	Ranking
Electricity tariffs for industrial players	$48 MWh/	
Productivity adjusted wages		$3.3 hour/
Logistics Performance Index (1-5)	3.2	
Construction Costs (Indexed to US, % 0 is cheapest)	74	
Ease of getting credit (0-100)		50

Bottom 25%	Top 75%	Top 50%	Top 25%

Definitions

#	SCORECARD SECTION	DEFINITIONS
1	Market size	Size of market in value/volume in KSA and/or Region (MENA/GCC) covering future projections based on available estimates from published /government sources
2	Business drivers	A select number of factors that will influence future demand for the related product/service
3	Investment highlights	An overview of key financial metrics summarizing the investment opportunity along with the expected return based on the suggested investment size
4	Value proposition	Summary of key differentiators that position KSA as a strategic choice over other regional/global peers
5	Market readiness	An overview of KSA market structure, market maturity and level of participation by local and global players
6	Global trends	Latest business developments within the sector/product category
7	Scalability and localization	Ease of scaling the business across the value chain or into new adjacent products or geographies that would maximize the opportunity's investment returns and the ability and potential to locally manufacture the product and its components
8	Import dependency	An overview of the countries from which Saudi Arabia is importing the product and their value/volume and share in total imports
9	Value chain analysis	The process or activities that would potentially need to be carried out to deliver the underlying product or service
10	Key stakeholders	Government institutions, organizations, and/or authorities that participate or influence the market for the underlying product/service
11	Enablers	Factors that enable investment in the underlying opportunity
12	Cost of doing business in KSA	Key factors that position KSA as a competitive destination for investment in the region. Productivity adjusted wages do not include cost of $1.23/hour towards annual recurring charges including work permit, resident identity (iqama) and health insurance

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